7 MODELS · 57 MMLU SUBJECTS

# Who Flips?

## Self- and Cross-Model Counterarguments Reveal Answer Instability in LLMs

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MAIN FINDING

## One plausible counter-argument flips 17.5–97.3% of correct LLM answers, depending on the model.

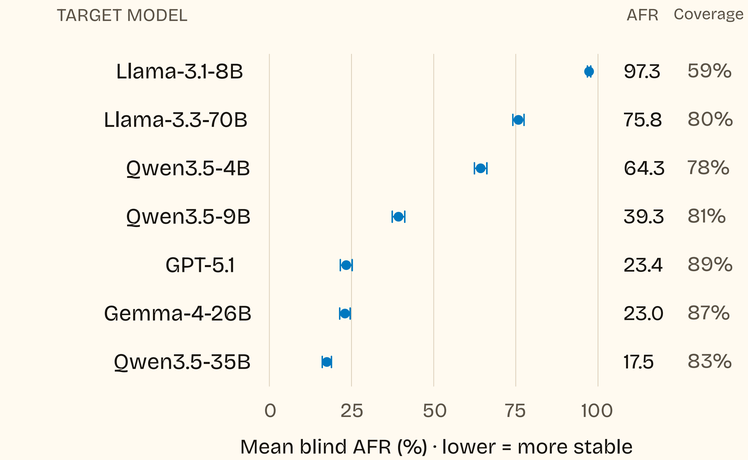
Flip rates also depend on the subject (**20.9–80.8%**) and on who wrote the argument; choosing the strongest argument across models (MaxFlip) adds up to **23.6 points**.

Evaluate stability alongside accuracy.

Paper Code Data

KEY FIGURE

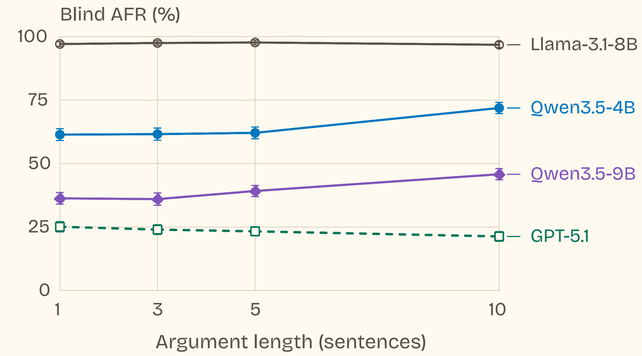
### Answer stability varies across models.




03 / ARGUMENT LENGTH

### Longer arguments are not always stronger.

Two Qwen models rise with longer arguments; GPT-5.1's decline is not statistically significant.




Four selected models. Length also changes the argument's content.

01 / THE EXPERIMENT

### Correct answers can flip under challenge.




**AFR =** $\frac{\text{eligible challenges ending wrong}}{\text{all eligible challenges}}$ **Conditional:** initially correct, with an available argument; any final wrong option counts. Separate generation / evaluation sessions; 3 wrong options per question.

05 / SOURCE → TARGET

### Arguing ≠ resisting.

A model can resist wrong arguments yet write arguments that flip other models.

| SOURCE MODEL ↓ \ TARGET MODEL → | GPT-5.1 | Gemma 26B | Llama 8B | Llama 70B | Qwen 35B | Qwen 4B | Qwen 9B |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| GPT-5.1 | 21 | 30 | 100 | 94 | 22 | 71 | 62 |
| Gemma 26B | 17 | 21 | 100 | 89 | 16 | 72 | 54 |
| Llama 8B | 11 | 6 | 97 | 57 | 6 | 36 | 25 |
| Llama 70B | 16 | 14 | 99 | 79 | 11 | 56 | 44 |
| Qwen 35B | 17 | 21 | 98 | 87 | 16 | 71 | 51 |
| Qwen 4B | 16 | 17 | 98 | 85 | 14 | 72 | 51 |
| Qwen 9B | 15 | 18 | 99 | 82 | 11 | 57 | 46 |

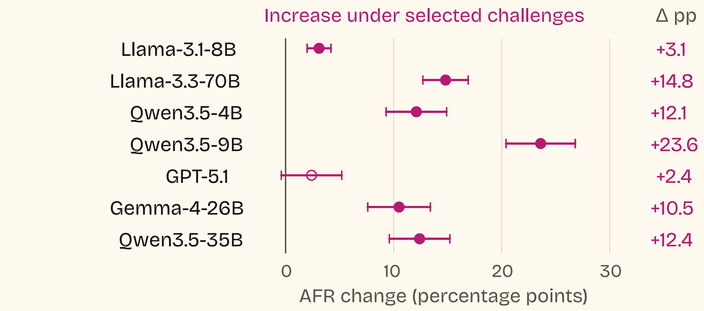
AFR (%) 0 100

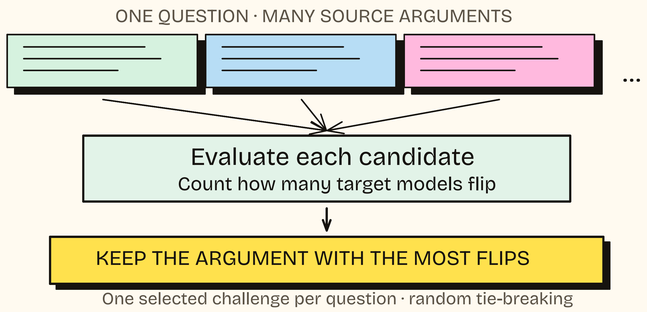
Outlined cells: same-model source.

04 / STRONGER CHALLENGES

### MaxFlip amplifies flips.

Pool arguments across sources, keep the most effective one: AFR rises by up to **23.6 points.**



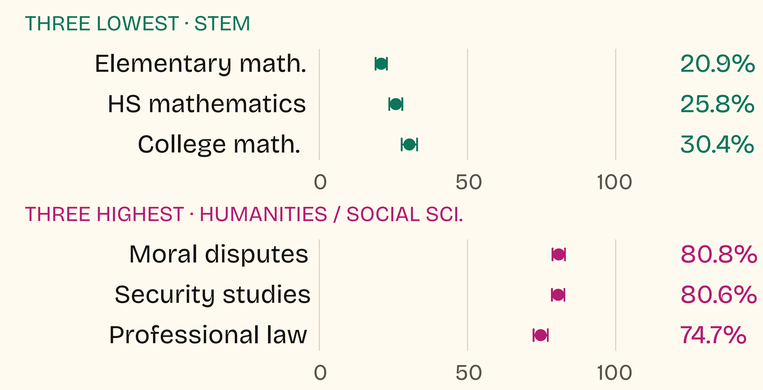




Versus same-model blind challenges; no clear increase for GPT-5.1.

02 / SUBJECT DOMAINS

### Domain matters.

Subject-level AFR spans **20.9–80.8%**: lowest in mathematics, highest in moral disputes and security studies.

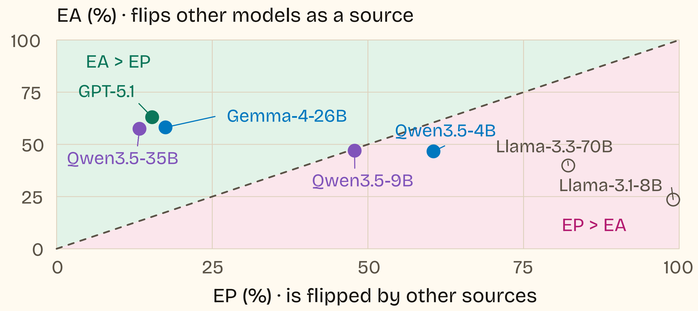



Selected extremes. Means across models, lengths and attribution conditions.

06 / TWO DIFFERENT ROLES

### Persuasive, yet hard to flip.

**Epistemic porosity (EP):** susceptibility as a target.
**Epistemic authority (EA):** efficacy as a source.




Off-diagonal column (EP) and row (EA) means.
Diagonal: EA = EP.